

ISO 9001:2015 — Audit Preparation Companion

Example LLC

Calibration & Test Measurement ·
Greenville SC

Supporting the quality system described in your handbook;
tailored for your team, processes, and traceability-critical
customer sectors.

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Prepared for:	Example LLC, Dana Whitfield, Owner
Companion to:	AlignedDocs QMS Manual v1.0

How to Use This Audit Preparation Companion

This document supports **Example LLC** in preparing for your ISO 9001:2015 external (Stage 1/2) audit. It is individually tailored to your **calibration and test measurement activities**, referencing real names, processes, and objectives from your QMS manual. For each ISO 9001 chapter, you'll find:

- Specific, likely auditor questions — phrased for your team and business model
- What evidence the auditor will expect (documents, records, sign-offs, logs, meeting notes...)
- How recent/frequent evidence must be (retention, recency, cycles)
- A step-by-step preparation roadmap to progress from documentation to a readiness checkpoint

Focus on practical record assembly and coaching your team leads — this guide makes it clear what to expect, but **does not guarantee certification**. It is not a substitute for your own critical review.

1. Auditor Question Catalogue

-] How does Example LLC ensure that all calibrations are directly traceable to NIST standards, and what process is in place if a required traceability break is detected?
-] Your manual lists customers in the automotive and aerospace sectors with strict documentation requirements. Show how your workflows (from job intake by Theresa Nguyen through certificate preparation and shipment) assure certificate authenticity and data integrity for these regulated customers.
-] When Example LLC uses external calibration providers for reference standards, what criteria and records does Kevin Park maintain to assure their continued accreditation and reliability?
-] Describe how Example LLC identifies and reviews changing external requirements (customer, NIST, OSHA, or sector-specific) and how these updates are incorporated into your documented procedures.
-] You state that losing another customer due to lack of ISO 9001 compliance is a business risk. How is this risk tracked or reviewed at management level, and what actions are taken to address it?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Master list(s) of current NIST-traceable reference standards (with due dates, certificates, and usage logs)
- ☐ Supplier evaluation/approval records for external calibration providers (names, accreditations, periodic reviews signed by Kevin Park/Dana Whitfield)
- ☐ Documented process flow — job intake to shipment; system logs showing end-to-end certificate traceability
- ☐ Management meeting notes or review logs where external requirements and business risks are discussed (including reference to risks around traceability or ISO certification loss)

- Procedures for updating QMS documents in response to regulatory or customer requirement changes, with evidence of review by Marcus Bell and approval by Dana Whitfield

TIMING & FREQUENCY REQUIREMENTS

- Reference standards must have current, valid external calibration (as of audit date); overdue standards or lapses must be explained and supported with corrective action records
- Supplier evaluations: Performed initially, then at planned intervals (at least annually recommended for key calibration providers)
- Records of process reviews, risk reviews, and external requirement updates: Most recent within the past 12 months
- Document retention: Minimum 10 years for calibration and certificate records, or as per contract/customer or applicable US regulatory requirements

2. Auditor Question Catalogue

-] Present the signed, current quality policy for Example LLC. How is it made available to staff, and how is its relevance maintained among bench technicians and support staff?
-] Example LLC sets a target of reducing certificate corrections to 2 per year by end of 2026. What is the process for monthly tracking, who reviews the data, and how is underperformance (six corrections in 2025) addressed?
-] Who approves changes to the quality objectives at Example LLC, how is progress assessed, and what actions are taken if targets for on-time delivery or reference standard management are missed?
-] When recurring errors are identified (e.g., in certificate data), how does leadership determine whether corrective action is training, procedural, or systems-based — and who documents this decision?
-] How and when does Dana Whitfield communicate quality priorities and commitments to the team (including bench technicians and front office)?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Signed quality policy statement, showing latest approval by Dana Whitfield, with version/review date
- ☐ Monthly reports/tracking logs for certificate correction rate, on-time delivery, and reference standard overdue incidents (with named owner: Marcus Bell)
- ☐ Records of management review meetings including quality objective assessments, agenda, attendance (Dana Whitfield, Marcus Bell, support staff)
- ☐ Corrective action logs, root cause investigations, and records of how repeated certificate/data errors are escalated and addressed

- Communication/training records or evidence (email briefings, meeting attendance, posted policies in work areas, or digital QMS system updates)

TIMING & FREQUENCY REQUIREMENTS

- Quality policy: Most recent approval date must be visible; annual review is best practice (evidence should be within past year)
- Quality objectives: Assessed at each annual management review (minimum once per year) and via regular metrics monitoring (monthly for key KPIs)
- Management review minutes: Most recent within 12 months
- Corrective action and root cause records: Kept updated as per incident; retention minimum 10 years for audit trail, or as per client/US requirements

3. Auditor Question Catalogue

- How does Example LLC ensure all calibrations are performed with current procedures and forms — and how is version control maintained by Marcus Bell and Dana Whitfield?
- Describe how jobs are logged and scheduled by Theresa Nguyen, and what records exist from customer inquiry through completion and shipment (including digital or physical traceability).
- When a customer complaint or certificate correction is received, show how it is logged, reviewed by Dana Whitfield, and prompt corrective action is initiated by Marcus Bell. What records exist?
- How does Kevin Park monitor the calibration status of in-house reference standards, and what documentation is kept when standards are sent/returned from external providers?
- What is the process for onboarding and training new bench technicians, and how are ongoing training needs identified and recorded, especially following corrective actions?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Document control log, showing revision numbers/effective dates of all QMS documents; approved by Dana Whitfield
- ☐ Job records: Intake log (by Theresa Nguyen), customer contact logs, scheduling records, bench notes, certificate files, shipment records
- ☐ Complaint and correction log: All received complaints, related bench/measurement records, corrective actions, and closure documentation
- ☐ Reference standard tracking log (digital or paper) with recalibration due dates, records of external provider certificates, out-of-tolerance incidents, and escalation notes (involving Kevin Park, Marcus Bell, Dana Whitfield)
- ☐ Training matrix, onboarding checklists or training records, and evidence of targeted sessions in response to corrective actions

- Supplier management file for accredited external calibration providers, including current accreditations and evidence of periodic review

TIMING & FREQUENCY REQUIREMENTS

- Document reviews: At least annually; emergency update immediately upon finding if process/procedure gaps are discovered
- Job/certificate records: Created in real time; must be available from at least the past 3–6 months for audit, with 10-year retention per QMS/manual
- Reference standard calibration: All must be current; overdue records require evidence of escalation and corrective action
- Training records: Onboarding documented for all new technicians; ongoing/targeted training recorded promptly following identification of need
- Supplier reviews: At least annually; maintain trail of external provider certificates and approvals

4. Auditor Question Catalogue

- How is the internal audit program planned to ensure that every core and support process (including calibration, certificate accuracy, supplier management, and document control) is reviewed at least annually?
- Show internal audit documentation — what types of findings are recorded, and how are improvement actions tracked through to closure by Marcus Bell?
- Present the most recent management review meeting documentation, including who attended (Dana Whitfield, Marcus Bell, relevant staff) and what improvement initiatives were agreed upon.
- How does Example LLC analyze recurring issues (such as frequent certificate corrections or late reference standard recalibrations), document root cause analysis, and select appropriate corrective or preventive actions?
- How is the effectiveness of improvements measured for key objectives (e.g., reduction of certificate corrections, improved on-time delivery), and what ongoing data is used in these assessments?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Internal audit procedure and plan/schedule (approved by Marcus Bell), with at least one cycle completed before Stage 2 audit
- ☐ Audit reports, checklists, findings log, and records of completed corrective actions with closure evidence
- ☐ Management review minutes: agenda, attendance (with participant names), decisions made, action items assigned and closed
- ☐ Corrective and preventive action logs: documented investigations, root causes, actions taken, dates, and follow-up/closure signoff
- ☐ Performance trend data for KPIs (e.g., certificate correction rate, on-time delivery) with evidence reviewed over several months

- Copy of sample communications (internal/external) relating to improvements, improvement pilots, or client notifications if applicable

TIMING & FREQUENCY REQUIREMENTS

- Internal audits: Must cover all QMS processes at least annually; sample evidence from the past audit cycle
- Management reviews: Held at planned intervals, generally at least annually; minutes for the most recent 12-month period required
- Corrective action evidence: Open items promptly updated, closed items retained as per QMS records retention (minimum 10 years or as per contract/regulations)
- KPI tracking: Data and trend analysis should extend back at least 3 months, ideally over a complete year if available

5. Preparation Roadmap for Example LLC

INITIAL: Immediate Actions (Week 1)

- ☐ Brief all team members (Theresa Nguyen, Marcus Bell, Kevin Park, Dana Whitfield, bench technicians) on timeline and roles for audit prep
- ☐ Introduce routine recordkeeping, ensuring every calibration, complaint, and corrective action is logged in the lab management software and/or physical log
- ☐ Review physical and digital control of QMS procedures: confirm that only current, approved versions by Marcus Bell/Dana Whitfield are accessible and in use
- ☐ Circulate or post signed quality policy (latest version) in the lab and digitally where accessible by all staff

BUILD-UP: Real Data Collection (Weeks 2–6)

- ☐ Ensure regular tracking and reporting of all 3 KPIs: certificate correction rate, on-time delivery rate, and reference standard overdue incidents
- ☐ Gather and retain all calibration certificate records, complaint/correction logs, completed bench notes, and job intake/dispatch logs — actual work samples, not just templates
- ☐ For each external calibration provider, assemble current accreditation records and recent supplier reviews signed by Kevin Park/Dana Whitfield
- ☐ Assign and carry out at least one internal audit (planned by Marcus Bell) spanning job intake, calibration process, document control, and supplier management — keep checklists, findings, and any nonconformities or improvement notes
- ☐ Document any actual corrective actions, including evidence of root cause and closure (especially for repeated certificate or turnaround issues)
- ☐ Initiate or record targeted training sessions if corrective actions highlight skills/process gaps

PENULTIMATE: Management Review & Closure (Weeks 7–10)

- ☐ Plan and execute a management review meeting (agenda including KPIs, audit results, customer complaint trends, supplier performance, resource planning)
- ☐ Document minutes, attendance (Dana Whitfield, Marcus Bell, support staff), agreed action items, and update QMS/documentation as needed
- ☐ Re-assess completeness and traceability of all records and evidence files as per sections above

FINAL: Pre-Audit Check (Last 2 Weeks Before Stage 2)

- ☐ Conduct a mock audit (internal or with external consultant if available) using the question catalogue in this document
- ☐ Verify at least 3 months of real evidence has been generated — not just recent/retrospective files
- ☐ Confirm every item in "Evidence Required" is available, organized, dated, signed where required, and accessible in case of spot check by auditor
- ☐ Review with each staff member (esp. Theresa Nguyen, Marcus Bell, Kevin Park, bench technicians) their specific roles and what records/auditor questions they may be asked
- ☐ Resolve any last documented nonconformities/corrective actions; update and sign off as closed

Ongoing

- ☐ Continue all QMS, calibration, and recordkeeping practices as actual live operation — auditors expect evidence the system is "lived," not just written